

TROGLODYTES: ENVIRONMENTAL WARRENS



TROGLODYTES: ENVIRONMENTAL WARRENS IS A monster supplement for 5e that presents troglodytes not as a single cave-dwelling nuisance, but as a species that adapts brutally to the environments it inhabits. While their culture remains primitive and dominance-driven, different warrens evolve

distinct physical traits and hunting strategies based on the terrain around them.

The intent of this product is mechanical clarity and encounter variety without CR inflation. Each ladder progresses from hatchling through scout and enforcer before culminating in a tyrant that dominates its warren. These troglodytes are territorial predators designed for tight underground battlefields, ambush encounters, and hostile environments where movement, light, and terrain shape combat as much as raw strength.

Cultural complexity is intentionally minimal. Troglodytes do not build civilizations or political structures. They form brutal warrens ruled by the strongest creature present. Whether these environmental differences represent evolutionary divergence, isolated breeding lines, or simple adaptation is left entirely to the GM. Use these stat blocks as tools for caves, deep tunnels, volcanic chambers, and flooded caverns wherever primitive subterranean predators might thrive.

THE CLASSIC WARRENS

Classic troglodytes represent the familiar subterranean tribes found throughout cave systems and abandoned tunnels. Their warrens are crude nests of bone piles, fungus growth, and territorial scent markings. Hierarchy is maintained through violence, intimidation, and pheromonal dominance.

Encounters with classic troglodytes emphasize ambush tactics, tunnel fighting, and overwhelming numbers. Scouts stalk prey through darkness, enforcers maintain order through brute force, and tyrants rule through sheer physical superiority.

THE VOLCANIC WARRENS

Volcanic troglodytes inhabit lava tubes, sulfur caverns, and volcanic rifts where intense heat shapes their physiology. Their scales develop heat-resistant properties, and their attacks carry burning volcanic energy.

Volcanic encounters emphasize hazardous terrain, smoke-filled chambers, and aggressive shock assaults near magma flows and sulfur vents. These troglodytes are comfortable fighting in conditions that would cripple most other creatures.

THE DEEP WARRENS

Deep troglodytes dwell far below the upper cave systems where light has never existed. Their eyesight diminishes, replaced by extreme sensitivity to vibration and movement through the stone itself.

Encounters with deep troglodytes emphasize darkness, tremor detection, and disorienting underground environments. Light becomes a weapon against them, while complete darkness gives them a terrifying advantage.

THE MIRESTONE WARRENS

Mirestone troglodytes inhabit flooded cavern networks, underground lakes, and limestone chambers where water dominates the terrain. Their bodies adapt to amphibious movement and ambush tactics from beneath the surface.

Encounters in mirestone warrens emphasize underwater movement, grappling attacks, and sudden assaults from dark pools. These troglodytes prefer to drag prey into water where escape becomes far more difficult.

CLASSIC TROGLODYTE ROSTER

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Troglodyte Hatchling	0	Newly emerged hatchling raised in the breeding pits of crude cave warrens.
Troglodyte Scout	1/8	Tunnel hunter that stalks prey through darkness and vibration before an ambush.
Troglodyte Enforcer	1/2	Dominant brute that maintains tribal order through intimidation and violence.
Troglodyte Tyrant	3	Alpha ruler of the warren who commands through strength and pheromonal authority.

VOLCANIC TROGLODYTE ROSTER

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Volcanic Troglodyte Hatchling	0	Heat-scarred young raised within lava tubes and sulfur vents.
Volcanic Troglodyte Scout	1/8	Ember-scaled hunter that stalks prey through smoke and ash.
Volcanic Troglodyte Enforcer	1/2	Lava-hardened warrior capable of fighting amid burning stone and magma heat.
Volcanic Troglodyte Magma Tyrant	4	Volcanic warren ruler whose burning attacks dominate lava chambers.

DEEP TROGLODYTE ROSTER

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Deep Troglodyte Hatchling	0	Pale hatchling born in total darkness far below the surface.
Deep Troglodyte Scout	1/8	Blind hunter relying on tremors, scent, and air movement.
Deep Troglodyte Enforcer	1/2	Powerful subterranean brute that dominates tunnels through vibration awareness.
Deep Troglodyte Void Tyrant	4	Ancient ruler of the lightless depths sensing movement through stone itself.

MIRESTONE TROGLODYTE ROSTER

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Mirestone Troglodyte Hatchling	0	Amphibious young raised in flooded limestone caverns and underground rivers.
Mirestone Troglodyte Scout	1/8	Silent aquatic hunter striking from beneath dark cavern waters.
Mirestone Troglodyte Enforcer	1/2	Brutal grappler that drags prey into submerged tunnels and pools.
Mirestone Troglodyte Drowned Tyrant	3	Dominant amphibious ruler controlling a flooded cavern warren.

CLASSIC TROGLODYTES

TROGLODYTE HATCHLING

Small humanoid (troglodyte), chaotic evil

Armor Class 11

Hit Points 5 (2d6 – 2)

Speed 20 ft., climb 10 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
8 (-1)	12 (+1)	8 (-1)	5 (-3)	10 (+0)	6 (-2)

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 10

Languages Troglodyte

Challenge 0 (10 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +2

Skittish. If a creature larger than this troglodyte hits it with an attack, this troglodyte can move up to 10 feet without provoking opportunity attacks.

ACTIONS

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 3 (1d4+1) piercing damage.

- Hatchlings rarely fight alone; they swarm briefly then scatter into tunnels.
- They are usually encountered near egg pits or guarded breeding chambers.



VOLCANIC TROGLODYTE SCOUT

Medium humanoid (troglodyte), chaotic evil

Armor Class 13 (leather)

Hit Points 13 (3d8)

Speed 30 ft., climb 20 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
11 (+0)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)	8 (-1)	12 (+1)	8 (-1)

Damage Resistance fire

Skills Stealth +4, Perception +3

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 13

Languages Troglodyte

Challenge 1/8 (25 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +2

Ash Camouflage. While in smoke, ash, or dim volcanic light, this troglodyte has advantage on Dexterity (Stealth) checks.

ACTIONS

Spear. *Melee or Ranged Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft. range 20/60 ft, one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) piercing damage plus 3 (1d6) fire damage.

- Scouts strike from smoke-filled tunnels where visibility is poor.
- They often coordinate ambushes near lava vents.



DEEP TROGLODYTE ENFORCER

Medium humanoid (troglodyte), chaotic evil

Armor Class 14 (natural armor)

Hit Points 42 (6d8 + 15)

Speed 30 ft., climb 20 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	11 (+0)	16 (+3)	7 (-2)	12 (+1)	9 (-1)

Skills Athletics +6

Senses darkvision 60 ft., tremorsense 30 ft., passive Perception 11

Languages Troglodyte

Challenge 1/2 (100 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +2

Light Sensitivity. While in bright light, this troglodyte has disadvantage on attack rolls and on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on sight.

Stone Sense. While standing on stone, this troglodyte has advantage on attack rolls against creatures it detects with tremorsense.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. This troglodyte makes two claw attacks.

Claw. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 8 (1d8 + 4) slashing damage.

- Enforcers dominate narrow tunnels where tremorsense makes ambush impossible to avoid.
- They often attack from complete darkness.



MIRESTONE TROGLODYTE DROWNED TYRANT

Medium humanoid (troglodyte), chaotic evil

Armor Class 16 (natural armor)

Hit Points 110 (13d8 + 52)

Speed 30 ft., swim 40 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
21 (+5)	12 (+1)	19 (+4)	10 (+0)	13 (+1)	12 (+1)

Saving Throws Con +6

Skills Athletics +7, Intimidation +3

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 11

Languages Troglodyte

Challenge 3 (700 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +2

Amphibious. This troglodyte can breathe air and water.

Water Dominance. While in water, this troglodyte has advantage on attack rolls.

Drag Under. If this troglodyte hits a creature with two claw attacks in the same turn while both are in water, the target must succeed on a DC 15 Strength saving throw or be pulled 10 ft. underwater and knocked prone.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. This troglodyte makes three claw attacks.

Claw. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 11 (1d10 + 5) slashing damage.

- This tyrant controls underground lakes and flooded cavern systems.
- It prefers to fight while submerged, forcing enemies to struggle in deep water.



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